

## Expertspeak



**Mita Shukla**

Dietician, Kolkata

**What she eats:**

**Breakfast:** Chapatti and subzi, or boiled rice and dal. A bowl of curd is a must.

**Mid-morning:** A seasonal fruit.

**Lunch:** A very small portion of rice, fish and vegetable.

**Evening:** A cup of tea with puffed rice or fried dal.

**Dinner:** An early one, with rice, dal, one vegetable and fish.

**Her tips**

Eat one fruit every day, especially after lunch, for better iron absorption.



**Dr V. Mohan**

Diabetologist, Chennai

**What he eats:**

**Breakfast:** A Variety of seasonal fruits. Sometimes oatmeal.

**Lunch:** Essentially vegetarian, boiled rice and curry.

**Snacking:** Mostly fruits, tea.

**Dinner:** Salad, whole wheat chapatti, pulses, vegetables and fish or chicken.

**His tips**

Replace sweets and desserts with fruits for snacking and also when eating out. Replace all types of polished rice and refined flours with whole grains.



**Ishii Khosla**

Nutritionist, Delhi

**What she eats:**

**Breakfast:** Tea with 20 almonds, egg or paneer and vegetable juice.

**Lunch:** Yogurt with pulses, vegetables, brown rice or oatmeal porridge with sprouts.

**Evening:** Tea with chilla/peanuts/roasted whole grain mixture.

**Dinner:** Soup, fish/chicken/tofu with vegetables and whole grain toast.

**Her tips**

Learn to balance calories. Say no to trans-fats. Include fresh vegetables and fruits.

creasingly common in urban India as the survey showed a jump of 12 per cent in the last decade. While the consumption of chicken has risen from 9 per cent to 27 per cent in city households, egg consumption has gone up in both urban and rural India. The survey showed a 30 per cent increase in the consumption of cooking oil, although the intake of vanaspati oil is down from 40 per cent to 21 per cent in the cities.

According to nutrition expert Dr B. Sivakumar, these surveys are useful in documenting the percentage increase in monthly intake, but they don't really give out the big picture. While he agrees that certain shifts have taken place—people prefer polished grains over coarse grains—he says there are a lot of factors to be considered before labelling something as 'harmful' or 'good for health'. "Any food, considered healthy, cooked in a particular medium and in a particular way, can be harmful if prepared

in a different way," he elaborates.

Experts agree that it is often not what we eat, but how we eat, that determines our health. Our busy lives have made dinner the biggest meal of the day. Sivakumar elaborates, "Dinner should be light. It gives more blood sugar and energy at a time when the body is resting and physically inactive. There may be inadequate nutrients during the day when the body badly needs them for mental and physical work." In fact it explains why we often feel lethargic in the morning. The other devil could be our new communications devices. Be it the television or the cell phone, there should be no distraction while eating. "Sit comfortably in a pleasant atmosphere and concentrate on food alone," advises ayurvedic medicine expert Dr Preeti Chhabra.

In India, it is difficult to determine what is healthy to eat as there is a plethora of choices.

**63%**

Indians still use unrefined oil as a cooking medium.